

英検2級 リーディング問題

2023年度 第1回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



ReadPassで復習

解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (1) **A:** Dave asked me to marry him. Do you think I should say yes?
B: You have to use your own (1) to decide. No one else can do it for you.
1 income 2 convention 3 judgment 4 geography
- (2) **A:** What did you think of my essay, Jill?
B: Well, some of the explanations you gave are a bit (2). Maybe you should make those parts clearer.
1 harmful 2 previous 3 certain 4 vague
- (3) Colin had been getting bad grades in math for a long time, but he did not do anything about it. Finally, he decided to (3) the problem and ask his teacher for help.
1 alter 2 impress 3 honor 4 confront
- (4) The St. Patrick's Day parade started on 10th Avenue and (4) slowly to the center of town.
1 illustrated 2 reminded 3 proceeded 4 defended

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q10

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) Before there were motor vehicles, people often used (5) that were pulled by horses to make long journeys.
1 carriages 2 fantasies 3 puzzles 4 luxuries
- (6) Jane bought five silk handkerchiefs. Because she was going to give each one to a different friend, she asked the salesclerk to wrap them (6).
1 legally 2 financially 3 accidentally 4 individually
- (7) In the first lecture, Professor Smith (7) how important it was to take good notes. He mentioned it three or four times.
1 engaged 2 divided 3 buried 4 stressed
- (8) Yesterday, there was a small fire at a house on the street where Ben lives. Firefighters (8) water onto the fire and soon put it out.
1 sprayed 2 demanded 3 awarded 4 punished
- (9) In the game Invasion!, each player tries to take over other countries and build an (9).
1 urgency 2 offspring 3 empire 4 impulse
- (10) In science class, Ms. Dixon lit a candle and asked her students to look at the (10). She told them that the hottest part was where it was blue.
1 triumph 2 religion 3 flame 4 luggage

大問1 語彙・文法 Q11-Q15

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (11) Margaret's parents finally bought her a piano after she promised to practice every day, but she quit playing after just two months. They were very (11) her.
1 capable of 2 inspired by 3 attracted to 4 disappointed in
- (12) **A:** I'm sorry that I came home late. Did you have dinner without me?
B: Yes. We were very hungry, but I (12) some food for you. I'll heat it up now.
1 cut down 2 hung up 3 took after 4 set aside
- (13) Due to construction work on Bayside Street, the electricity to the houses on the street had to be (13) for two hours.
1 heard of 2 turned over 3 shut off 4 ruled out
- (14) Tau Electronics has confirmed that it will be (14) its new smartphone next month. The release has been delayed for several months due to technical issues.
1 bringing out 2 falling for 3 picking on 4 giving off
- (15) Water that falls as snow and rain in the Andes Mountains travels thousands of kilometers down the Amazon River and eventually (15) the Atlantic Ocean.
1 flows into 2 runs across 3 hands over 4 digs up

大問1 語彙・文法 Q16-Q20

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(16) Applicants for jobs at Swandon Foods must apply (16). They are not allowed to mail their application forms. Instead, they must take them to the store manager or his assistant.

- 1 at ease 2 at length 3 in person 4 in detail

(17) The students in Jason's class take turns to look after things in the classroom. This week, Jason is (17) of checking that there is no trash on the floor at the end of each day.

- 1 for fear 2 in charge 3 on behalf 4 by way

(18) Jenny is an excellent cook. Her soups and stews are as good as (18) that are served in a restaurant.

- 1 none 2 any 3 other 4 few

(19) **A:** Mom, can I go to the park to play with Jimmy later?

B: Yes, (19) you finish your homework first.

- 1 provide 2 provided 3 to provide 4 only provide

(20) Ms. Misawa is very rich and lives in a huge house. Her kitchen is four times (20) other people's kitchens.

- 1 large from 2 size from 3 the large of 4 the size of

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q21-Q23

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(21)から(26)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Any Change?

Long ago, humans did not use money. Because they often could not produce everything that they needed, they traded some of their goods for goods made by others. Gradually, the goods that they exchanged were replaced by cash. For hundreds of years, metal coins and paper bills that can be exchanged for goods and services have been produced. Cash is convenient for many people because it is easy to carry. At the same time, though, it (21). Another disadvantage is that criminals have been able to produce fake coins and bills.

In the middle of the 20th century, plastic credit cards were introduced. They had security features to prevent them from being used by anyone except their owners. At first, their use was limited to wealthy people. Over time, however, they became (22). In the last few years, apps for smartphones that can be used in the same way as credit cards have also become popular. Because of this, some people are suggesting that we may soon see the end of cash.

Supporters of a "cashless" society in which all payments are made electronically argue that it would have several benefits. For example, people would not have to worry about keeping their wallets safe. However, some people are concerned that they might be unable to pay for the things they need because of a software error or a broken smartphone. Moreover, some people do not have bank accounts or credit cards, so their only option is to use coins and bills. (23), it seems as though societies will continue to use cash.

(21)

- 1 can be lost or stolen 2 is used for shopping online 3 can be recycled 4 is understood by almost everyone

(22)

- 1 thinner and lighter 2 more colorful and exciting 3 harder to use 4 more widely available

(23)

- 1 For now 2 Until then 3 With luck 4 By contrast

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q24-Q26

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(21)から(26)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

The Tale of Mejk Swenekafew

Recently, many people have been talking about "fake news" - news reports that are untrue. However, such reports have been around for a long time. They are sometimes used in order to get more people to read newspapers, watch TV programs, or visit online news sites. People also use fake news to spread their political or religious beliefs. However, (24) publishing fake news. In 1903 in the city of Clarksburg, West Virginia, fake news was used to check if a newspaper was really writing its own articles.

In the city, there were two rival newspapers, the Clarksburg Daily Telegram and the Clarksburg Daily News. The Daily Telegram's staff believed that the Daily News's reporters were (25). The Daily Telegram decided to check whether this was happening. It published a fake news story about a man who had been shot after an argument about a dog. The man's name was Mejk Swenekafew. Soon afterward, exactly the same news appeared in the Daily News. However, the reporters at the Daily News had not noticed that the name "Swenekafew" was actually "we fake news" written backward. They were forced to admit that they had copied the Daily Telegram's article.

These days, there is more pressure than ever on newspapers, news programs, and news websites to get more readers, viewers, and visitors. In order to do so, they need to report big news stories as quickly as possible. (26), they are constantly watching each other to make sure they have the latest stories. However, they need to be careful not to do the same thing that the Clarksburg Daily News did.

(24)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|------------------------------------|---|-------------------------------------|---|---------------------------------|---|----------------------------|
| 1 | these are not the only reasons for | 2 | there are rules to stop people from | 3 | many popular websites have been | 4 | some TV companies began by |
|---|------------------------------------|---|-------------------------------------|---|---------------------------------|---|----------------------------|

(25)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|--------------------|---|------------------|---|-----------------|---|----------------------|
| 1 | attending an event | 2 | planning to quit | 3 | being paid more | 4 | stealing its stories |
|---|--------------------|---|------------------|---|-----------------|---|----------------------|

(26)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|--------------|---|-----------|---|-------------|---|-------------------|
| 1 | Despite this | 2 | By chance | 3 | As a result | 4 | On the other hand |
|---|--------------|---|-----------|---|-------------|---|-------------------|

大問3A Speak-EZ Language School

メールを読み、次ページのQ27-Q29に答えなさい。

From: Karen Taylor
To: Tracy Mitchell
Date: June 4
Subject: Speak-EZ Language School

Thank you very much for inquiring about Spanish lessons at Speak-EZ Language School. Speak-EZ Language School has been giving high-quality lessons for over 30 years, and our teachers have helped thousands of students achieve their goals. Whether you want to learn Spanish for business situations, to chat with friends, to pass exams, or just for the fun of learning, we can offer a suitable program for you.

You mentioned that because you studied Spanish in high school but had not used it for several years, you were not sure which lesson to take. Don't worry - we offer a free language skills test. You can take the test once you have decided to join Speak-EZ Language School. One of our instructors will use the results to help you pick the right program for your ability and your goals. You can also take a free 20-minute private lesson to get an idea of the methods that we use at Speak-EZ Language School.

We offer both private and group lessons. Group lessons can be a great way to make new friends. However, no more than eight people can join each group lesson, so spaces are limited. You can also try our Speak-EZ Chat Sessions. These are hosted by one of our instructors and give students of all levels a chance to chat freely. Speak-EZ Chat Sessions are available every weekday evening.

大問3A Speak-EZ Language School

前ページのメールを読み、Q27-Q29に答えなさい。

(27) What is one thing that Karen Taylor says about Speak-EZ Language School?

- 1 It gives lessons in over 30 different languages.
- 2 It is planning to hire a new Spanish teacher.
- 3 It has teachers from all over the world.
- 4 It offers various types of courses.

(28) Ms. Mitchell said that she

- 1 did not know which class to sign up for.
- 2 had never studied Spanish before.
- 3 wanted more information about teaching methods.
- 4 was at high school with one of the instructors.

(29) Speak-EZ Chat Sessions

- 1 take place on Monday through Friday every week.
- 2 have a limited number of spaces per session.
- 3 are only available to advanced students.
- 4 focus on using foreign languages to make friends.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ30-Q33に答えなさい。

An Extraordinary Machine

Most of the machines that people in developed nations use were invented during the last 200 years. They make tasks easier for people and give them more time for other tasks and for leisure. However, which of these machines has changed society the most? Even though people spend more time with their TVs, computers, and smartphones, some historians argue that the impact of these inventions has been small compared with that of washing machines.

Before washing machines, clothes and sheets were washed by hand. For most of history, this has involved carrying the laundry to a river or a lake, wetting it, and rubbing it with rocks, sand, or soap to remove the dirt. Then, the laundry had to be put in water again, and the extra water was usually removed to make drying easier. Even if people had water in their homes, the laundry would have to be rubbed against a special board or hit with pieces of wood to make it clean. It was hard work that took a long time.

The first washing machines were operated by hand, and they still required a lot of hard work. Discovering how to use electricity to power these machines was a challenge because the combination of water and electricity is very dangerous. However, during the first half of the 20th century, inventors created electric machines that were able to automatically do most of the steps involved in washing. Before long, these machines became common in homes in wealthier parts of the world.

Automatic washing machines gave people more time and energy for other activities than any other new technology did. They used some of this extra time and energy to study and teach their children. This, in turn, led to improvements in the quality of everyone's lives in the places where washing machines became common. Even today, many people in the world still wash their clothes by hand. This means that, over the next few decades, washing machines will probably continue to make a big difference to the lives of billions of humans.

大問3B 長文設問 Q30-Q33

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(30) What do some historians say about the invention of washing machines?

- 1 It happened due to an important change in society.
- 2 It led to the development of TVs, computers, and smartphones.
- 3 It has had a major impact on the natural environment.
- 4 It has had a greater effect on society than other modern inventions.

(31) Cleaning clothes and sheets without washing machines was hard work because

- 1 the process of doing laundry involved several different stages.
- 2 the soap used to wash laundry had to be prepared by hand.
- 3 people had to travel long distances in order to dry their laundry.
- 4 people who did it had to wash many items to earn enough money.

(32) What was one challenge faced by people trying to invent electric washing machines?

- 1 Many people thought that they would not be as effective as washing laundry by hand.
- 2 The use of electricity was limited to a few homes in wealthier parts of the world.
- 3 They could not discover how to make a machine to do all the steps involved in washing.
- 4 Machines that involve both electricity and water can be very unsafe to work with.

(33) Washing machines have allowed people to

- 1 spend more time teaching themselves and their children.
- 2 use their energy for volunteer activities in their communities.
- 3 invent other machines to carry out tasks in the home.
- 4 live in parts of the world where there are many rivers and lakes.

大問3C 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ34-Q38に答えなさい。

Living the Dream

On average, people spend about one-third of their lives sleeping, and for about one-quarter of the time that they are asleep, they dream. Although scientists have learned a lot about the parts of people's brains that are involved in dreaming, they are still uncertain about the purpose of dreams. One reason for this is the variety of dreams that people have - they can be pleasant, scary, unusual, or very ordinary. On top of this, they often do not make sense and are mostly forgotten soon after waking up.

People have been trying to explain why we dream for thousands of years. Ancient people believed that dreams were messages from gods. More recently, it was suggested that dreams could tell us about hidden parts of our personalities. These days, most psychologists believe that one of the principal functions of dreaming is to review memories and strengthen them. This is important because to learn well, we must not only find new ideas and skills but also regularly recall them.

For a recent study, Erin Wamsley of Furman University in the United States invited 48 participants to spend the night at a special laboratory at the university. The participants were woken up several times during the night and asked to report what they had been dreaming about. The following morning, the participants tried to connect the content of their dreams with events in their lives. Wamsley found that over half the dreams could be connected to memories of experiences. This supports the idea that dreams play a role in learning.

However, Wamsley also found that about 25 percent of dreams were connected to specific future events in participants' lives, such as upcoming tests or trips. This, she believes, is evidence that another important function of dreaming is to give people a chance to prepare for these events. Moreover, Wamsley observed that these dreams were more common later in the night. One explanation that she offers is that our brains are aware of time even while we are sleeping. As we get closer to the start of a new day, our attention switches from reviewing past events to thinking about future ones.

大問3C 長文設問 Q34-Q38

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(34) What is one reason that scientists are uncertain about why people dream?

- 1 Several parts of people's brains are involved in dreaming.
- 2 Dreams do not usually appear to have a clear meaning.
- 3 People often do not want to describe their dreams honestly.
- 4 Different people sometimes have exactly the same dream.

(35) Modern psychologists think that

- 1 people discovered the reason that we have dreams thousands of years ago.
- 2 people's brains are able to exercise and grow larger by having dreams.
- 3 dreams allow people to hide parts of their personalities that they do not like.
- 4 dreams give people an opportunity to make their memories stronger.

(36) What was one thing that participants in Erin Wamsley's study were asked to do?

- 1 Discuss the content of their dreams with other participants in the study.
- 2 Relate what happened in their dreams to what was happening in their lives.
- 3 Try to wake themselves up as soon as they knew that they were dreaming.
- 4 Compare their own dreams with a list of dreams that people commonly have.

(37) Wamsley suggests that dreams about future events

- 1 happen because our brains know that we will wake up soon.
- 2 occur more often after tests or other stressful events.
- 3 are experienced just as often as dreams about the past.
- 4 probably stay in our memories longer than other dreams.

(38) Which of the following statements is true?

- 1 People long ago believed that gods spoke to them through dreams.
- 2 People dream for more than half of the time that they are asleep.
- 3 Participants in Wamsley's study mostly had dreams about future events.
- 4 Participants in Wamsley's study were observed in their own homes.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。



Q01-Q13	Q14-Q26	Q27-Q38
Q013 judgment 3	Q14 bringing out 1	Q27 It offers various types of courses. 4
Q02 vague 4	Q15 flows into 1	Q28 did not know which class to sign up for. 1
Q03 confront 4	Q16 in person 3	Q29 take place on Monday through Friday every week 1
Q04 proceeded 3	Q17 in charge 2	Q30 It has had a greater effect on society than other modern inventions 4
Q05 carriages 1	Q18 any 2	Q31 the process of doing laundry involved several different stages 1
Q06 individually 4	Q19 provided 2	Q32 Machines that involve both electricity and water can be very unsafe to work with 4
Q07 stressed 4	Q20 the size of 4	Q33 spend more time teaching themselves and their children 1
Q08 sprayed 1	Q21 can be lost or stolen 1	Q34 Dreams do not usually appear to have a clear meaning 2
Q09 empire 3	Q22 more widely available 4	Q35 dreams give people an opportunity to make their memories stronger 4
Q10 flame 3	Q23 For now 1	Q36 Relate what happened in their dreams to what was happening in their lives 2
Q11 disappointed in 4	Q24 these are not the only reasons for 1	Q37 happen because our brains know that we will wake up soon 1
Q12 set aside 4	Q25 stealing its stories 4	Q38 People long ago believed that gods spoke to them through dreams. 1
Q13 shut off 3	Q26 As a result 3	

学習記録

得点

_____ / 38

やり直す問題

メモ
